

Monday, 5 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 22° 13°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 21° 14°	MANCHESTER Drizzle 18° 15°	GLASGOW Drizzle 16° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Sinn Féin has confirmed it will co-operate with police investigating the ongoing Drumcree protest in Northern Ireland.

Protesters have remained on Garvaghy Road since last Sunday, amid fallout over a proposed Orange Lodge march. Sinn Féin leader Mary Lou McDonald says the party will work with the PSNI.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

A number of UK universities are reviewing partnerships with China, following a warning from MI5.

The security service cautioned that some institutions may have unintentionally aided Chinese espionage. This has prompted a closer look at various collaborations.

EDUCATION · UK
- 3

Debris in the engine was very likely the cause of a Spitfire crash last year, an investigation has found.

Squadron Leader Mark Long was tragically killed when the plane he was flying crashed in a field in May 2024. The findings shed light on the circumstances of the accident.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 4

The family of a teenager killed in a car crash is set to sue the driver who was acquitted of his death.

Kyle Marshall and another teenager died when a car driven by Charles Gray spun out of control in Stirling two years ago. The family is now pursuing civil action.

JUSTICE · UK
- 5

Conditions in prisons are 'awful', according to men released early from incarceration.

Prisoners leaving under the early release scheme have spoken out about their experiences. Their accounts highlight concerns about the state of UK correctional facilities.

JUSTICE · UK

What's coming up

- 1 **Glastonbury 2027 tickets have sold out in a blistering 42 minutes, leaving many hopefuls disappointed.**
Thousands of people joined the online queue, eager to secure their spot at Worthy Farm. The speed of the sell-out shows the festival's enduring popularity.

ON AIR – Did you try to get Glastonbury tickets? How quickly do you think they'll sell out next time?
FESTIVAL · 2027

- 2 **The British Museum is making changes to help ease queues for the Bayeux Tapestry exhibition.**
Measures include extended opening hours, an audio guide, and additional seating for visitors. They're hoping to improve the experience for everyone keen to see the historic artwork.

ON AIR – Have you ever queued for a major exhibition? Was it worth the wait?
EXHIBITION · NOW

- 3 **The highly anticipated Grand Theft Auto 6 soundtrack reveal has reignited the debate around digital music releases.**
Fred Again, PinkPantheress, and Travis Scott are among the artists providing new music for the blockbuster game. However, not all fans are happy with how the music is being released.

ON AIR – Are you excited for the GTA 6 soundtrack? Do you think digital releases are always the best way to get new music?
MUSIC · GAME

- 4 **An exhibition at the Tate is showcasing the hidden daytime dance revolution of the early bhangra scene in Bradford.**
Photographer Tim Smith's shots capture the energy of these 'daytimers' events. It's a fascinating look back at a vibrant and often overlooked part of UK music history.

ON AIR – Have you ever been to a 'daytimer' event? What kind of hidden music scenes do you remember?
EXHIBITION · NOW

- 5 **Craig Charles has paid tribute to Liverpool, the city that 'shaped him', to mark 50 years of his poetry.**
The presenter is celebrating half a century of writing poetry. His tribute comes as part of National Poetry Day celebrations.

ON AIR – What city or place has had the biggest influence on you?
POETRY · NOW

On the schedule

1

Wales' Elfyn Evans has ended Britain's 25-year wait for a World Rally Championship title!

The five-time runner-up clinched his first world championship after rival Oliver Solberg crashed in the final moments of Rally Italia Sardegna. What a moment for British motorsport!

ON AIR – What's the longest you've waited for a sporting hero to finally win a big title?

RALLY · UK

2

Max Verstappen secured his and Red Bull's first win of the year in a dramatic Malaysian Grand Prix.

The race started amid chaotic scenes and long delays, but Verstappen delivered a dominant drive. George Russell was unfortunately forced to retire.

ON AIR – Did you watch the Malaysian Grand Prix? What's the most chaotic race you've ever seen?

FORMULA 1 · GLOBAL

3

Novak Djokovic continues his quest for a first trophy of 2026, battling past world number two Alexander Zverev at the China Open.

Djokovic secured a hard-fought victory in the quarter-finals. He's showing that he still has those 'moments I still play for'.

ON AIR – Do you think Djokovic will win his first trophy of the year? Who's your pick for the China Open?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

4

Croatia captain Luka Modric says he was 'ashamed' of his side's 'catastrophic night' against England.

England delivered a strong performance against Croatia, leaving Modric to reflect on a difficult match for his team. It seems England really made their mark.

ON AIR – What's the most 'catastrophic night' you've seen in football? Or perhaps, the most glorious for England?

FOOTBALL · UK

5

Wu Yize has claimed his first ranking title since becoming world champion, marking a new high for Chinese snooker.

This victory means China will now have the top two players in the world rankings for the first time ever. It's a massive moment for the sport in China.

ON AIR – Are you a snooker fan? Which player do you think is going to dominate the sport next?

SNOOKER · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 Scientists are exploring the fascinating world of 'pattern recognition' in our everyday routines.**
It seems our brains are surprisingly good at spotting the familiar rhythm of daily life, from the postman's rounds to the neighbour's dog walk. It offers a subtle sense of order and comfort in our busy lives.
- 2 A new appreciation for 'the art of a well-placed cushion' is sweeping through home decor circles.**
Beyond just comfort, experts suggest that a thoughtfully arranged cushion can dramatically alter the mood and perceived cosiness of a room. It's all about strategic squishiness!
- 3 The simple act of 'doodling while on the phone' is being re-evaluated for its cognitive benefits.**
Far from being a sign of distraction, studies indicate that aimless sketching can actually help us focus better on conversations and even improve memory retention. So, grab a pen and let your mind wander!
- 4 There's a growing trend towards 'the mindful stacking of groceries' after a shopping trip.**
Rather than just haphazardly emptying the bags, some people are finding a quiet satisfaction in carefully arranging items in the fridge and cupboards. It's a small victory for order in the kitchen!
- 5 Experts are highlighting the calming effect of 'watching clouds drift by' on a lazy afternoon.**
This age-old pastime is being recognised for its ability to reduce stress and encourage a moment of peaceful reflection. A gentle reminder to look up once in a while!
- 6 The delightful movement of 'leaving small, smooth pebbles' with positive messages for others to find is gaining traction.**
These 'kindness stones' are a charming way to spread a little unexpected cheer in local parks and public spaces, bringing a smile to strangers' faces.
- 7 New research suggests that 'the satisfying click of a well-fitted lid' can bring a surprising sense of accomplishment.**
Whether it's a food container or a storage box, that definitive seal offers a tiny, everyday moment of triumph. Who knew tidiness could sound so good?

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: LOOKING AT HOW MANY 'BITS' OR 'CRUMBS' ARE AT THE BOTTOM OF THE PACKET, HOPING FOR MORE FLAVOUR!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of chocolate, especially if it's a fancy one. What is it?

ANSWER: BREAKING OFF A TINY, PERFECT SQUARE JUST TO SMELL IT BEFORE EATING THE REST.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit' just instantly brings back happy memories of childhood tea times or visits to grandparents, even if you haven't seen one in years?

Which biscuit holds a special place in your heart, and what lovely memory does it conjure up for you?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of kindness' that, when someone does it for you, truly makes your day, don't we?

What's a simple gesture that someone has done for you recently, or that you love to do for others, that just makes everything feel a little brighter?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that an octopus has three hearts? Two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that the common garden snail can travel at speeds of up to one mile per hour, making it one of the faster gastropods.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'smiley face' emoji was invented in the UK in 1982 by computer scientist Kevin Mackenzie.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar sources.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The first successful photograph was taken in 1826 by French inventor Nicéphore Niépce.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from outer space.
- There are more permutations of a standard deck of 52 playing cards than there are atoms on Earth.
- Penguins are the only birds that can't fly but can swim.

On this day

Day 278 of the year, 87 days left in 2026. Today World Space Week (October 4–10); Armed Forces Day (Indonesia); Christian feast day: Anna Schäffer; Christian feast day: Charitina of Amisus. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1985 — Nicola Roberts, English singer-songwriter
- 1943 — Steve Miller, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1975 — Monica Rial, American voice actress, director, and screenwriter
- 1959 — Kelly Joe Phelps, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2022)
- 1957 — Lee Thompson, English singer-songwriter and saxophonist
- 1942 — Richard Street, American singer-songwriter (died 2013)
- 1951 — Karen Allen, American actress
- 1946 — David Watson, English footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1988 — A Chilean opposition coalition defeats Augusto Pinochet in his re-election attempt.
- 1947 — President Truman makes the first televised Oval Office address.
- 1970 — The Public Broadcasting Service (PBS) is founded in the United States.[citation needed]

TODAY IN MUSIC

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TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1943 — World War II: Pacific Theater: Ninety-eight American POWs are executed by Japanese forces on Wake Island.
- 1938 — Holocaust: In Nazi Germany, Jews' passports are invalidated.
- 1966 — A reactor at the Enrico Fermi Nuclear Generating Station near Detroit suffers a partial meltdown.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 279 of the year, 86 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Bruno of Cologne; Christian feast day: Faith; Christian feast day: Blessed Isidore De Loor; Christian feast day: Blessed Juan de Palafox y Mendoza. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2000 — Addison Rae, American social media personality, dancer, and singer
- 1948 — Glenn Branca, American guitarist and composer (died 2018)
- 1931 — Eileen Derbyshire, English actress
- 1928 — Barbara Werle, American actress and singer (died 2013)
- 1978 — Ricky Hatton, English boxer and promoter (died 2025)
- 1974 — Jeremy Sisto, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1977 — Wes Ramsey, American actor
- 1951 — Clive Rees, Singaporean-Welsh rugby player and educator

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1973 — Egypt and Syria launch coordinated attacks against Israel, beginning the Yom Kippur War.
- 1981 — NLM CityHopper Flight 431 crashes in Moerdijk after taking off from Rotterdam The Hague Airport in the Netherlands, killing all 17 people on board.
- 1977 — The first prototype of the Mikoyan MiG-29, designated 9-01, makes its maiden flight.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1898 — Phi Mu Alpha Sinfonia, the largest American music fraternity, is founded at the New England Conservatory of Music.
- 1973 — Egypt and Syria launch coordinated attacks against Israel, beginning the Yom Kippur War.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar